

GARUDA

FLEUR DE SEL DE KAMPOT

*A whisper of the Ocean,
a Touch of Perfection.*

BRAND FOUNDATION

Voice, positioning, and the rules we build by.

Internal document · Version 1.0 · Kampot, Cambodia

01 In One Sentence

Garuda is a super-premium Cambodian fleur de sel — hand-harvested in Kampot, presented in a tin worthy of the finest tables, and built to put Cambodia on the same shelf as Guérande, Trapani and Maldon.

This is the sentence to use at a dinner, in a lift, over a handshake. Every other sentence in this document is downstream of it.

02 Mission & Vision

Mission

To earn Cambodian provenance a rightful place among the world's finest foods — by taking one remarkable ingredient, treating it with uncompromising craft, and presenting it without apology.

Vision

By 2030, Garuda is the reference for premium Cambodian products: the first name sommeliers, chefs, and gift-buyers speak when they speak of Cambodia.

Why this matters

Kampot has already taught the world its name through pepper. Salt is the second chapter. A country is known by what its craftspeople send abroad in small, beautiful boxes — and the box we are sending is this one.

03 Brand Values

Five principles. Every product decision, every line of copy, every supplier choice should be testable against these.

1. Provenance with a face

We name the place, the method, and the people. The salt is from Kampot. The herbs are Label Rouge from a cooperative in Provence. The hands that rake the pans and pack the tins are part of the story — not a marketing device bolted on later.

2. Patience over volume

Fleur de sel is what the sea gives when the wind is right. We do not chase volume at the cost of craft. Limited batches are a feature, not a shortfall.

3. Cultural respect, not cultural costume

Garuda draws on Khmer mythology and Cambodian land. We treat both with the weight they deserve. No tuk-tuk clichés, no temple silhouettes slapped onto a label, no borrowed exoticism. The tin is the homage.

4. Craft without compromise

Metal tin, magnetic-close box, food-safe finishes, considered typography. If a detail would embarrass us on a three-Michelin-star table, we fix it before it ships.

5. Signal, don't shout

Luxury is quiet. We let the object, the weight, the closure, and the silence around the product do the talking. We never oversell.

04 Positioning Statement

For discerning hosts, gift-givers, and hospitality buyers who treat what is on the table as a signal of care,

Garuda is the super-premium Cambodian fleur de sel

that brings a rare, mineral-rich crystal from Kampot to the world's finest tables — because Cambodia has always grown a salt worth this kind of ceremony, and it is time the world saw it presented as such.

The category we're in

Artisanal finishing salts — the narrow shelf that holds fleur de sel de Guérande, Maldon, Halen Môn, and the celebrated single-origin salts from Trapani, Jeju, and Kona.

The category we're not in

Table salt. Souvenir salt. Kitchen bulk. Tourist-market sachets. Flavoured pink rock curiosities.

05 Origin Story

Garuda begins where two things meet: a coast, and a bird.

The coast is Kampot — a strip of southern Cambodia where the monsoon withdraws, the sun returns, and seawater is coaxed across shallow clay pans by hand. When the wind is right and the humidity is kind, a fragile white crust forms on the surface. The harvesters call it the flower of the salt. They lift it off with a wooden rake before the afternoon breeze breaks it. A few kilograms per pan, on a good day.

The bird is Garuda — the great eagle of Khmer and Hindu myth, carrier of kings and emblem of the Kingdom. Carved into Angkor's lintels a thousand years ago, still flown on Cambodia's coat of arms today. Garuda is what Cambodia has always called its most beautiful things before sending them out into the world.

We source from a Kampot cooperative whose work we trust completely — fair-trade, rooted in women's employment, and tied tightly to the villages along the coast. We do not own the pans. We do not rake the salt. We pay properly, we buy only the flower, and we work closely with the people whose craft this already was long before we arrived. Our job is to honour it: to present what they harvest in a tin worthy of it, and to carry it to tables where the story can be told.

The first tin you open is a small act of arithmetic: a pinch of Cambodian sea, a coastline older than any language currently spoken in the country, and the work of hands that will never be on the label. That is what Garuda is for.

06 Product Architecture

Four SKUs. Each with a distinct role in the range.

Pure — Fleur de Sel

The flagship. The reference point. Unadorned Kampot fleur de sel, graded and hand-packed. Over 80 trace minerals, a sweet finish rather than a sharp one, and a crystal that dissolves slowly on the tongue. Silver-accented tin. This is the SKU a chef orders first.

Cold Smoked — Fleur de Sel Fumé

Cold-smoked over hardwood at low temperature so the crystal structure survives intact. Deep amber crust, savoury finish, made for grilled meats, eggs, and roasted root vegetables. Red-accented tin. Culinary, not novelty.

Herbes de Provence — Fleur de Sel aux Herbes

Fleur de sel blended with a Label Rouge herbes de Provence mix sourced from a cooperative in Aix-en-Provence: 27% savory, 27% rosemary, 27% oregano, 19% thyme, minimum 2% essential oils. Label Rouge is France's highest agricultural quality mark — not a marketing phrase. Green-accented tin. The most giftable SKU; often the one people fall in love with first.

24k Gold Flakes — Fleur de Sel à l'Or

Pure fleur de sel studded with food-grade 24-carat gold leaf. For celebration plates, cocktail rims, and the moments that justify the word 'occasion.' Gold-accented tin with gold foil details. The halo SKU: the one that defines the brand's ceiling and carries the margin that lets the others breathe.

Strategic note — the four SKUs are designed to work as a set. Pure establishes credibility with chefs. Smoked proves technical range. Herbes is the gateway purchase for gift-buyers. Gold is the halo that reframes the whole line as luxury. A retailer who stocks the four together earns a different shelf than one stocking one or two.

07 Competitive Landscape

The reference set (aspirational peers)

- **Fleur de Sel de Guérande (France)** — the category-defining French artisanal salt. The shelf position we want — and the brand permission we need to earn in year one.
- **Maldon (UK)** — different crystal (pyramid flake), same shelf. Chef-endorsed, widely distributed, still feels artisanal. Proof that a single-origin salt can become a global reference.
- **Halen Môn (Wales) & Trapani (Sicily)** — strong regional identity, design-led presentation, solid export footprints. Useful templates for how we present Kampot abroad.

The anti-positioning (what we refuse to be)

Two Cambodian competitors exist and they tell us exactly what Garuda must not look like.

La Plantation / Kirirom	Garuda
Eco-friendly cardboard packaging	Food-grade metal tin with magnetic-close box
Tourist-market / souvenir shelf	Hotel bar, concept store, fine grocery
Commodity-adjacent pricing	Super-premium pricing anchored to Guérande and above
Range sprawl: pepper, salt, spices, sauces	Disciplined single category — salt, done properly
Rustic, 'Cambodia as craft market' aesthetic	Quiet luxury, 'Cambodia as fine origin' aesthetic

La Plantation and Kirirom are not the enemy. They have done important work building awareness of Kampot as an origin. But their packaging language places them on the same shelf as cashews in jute bags. Garuda's job is to prove a different shelf exists for Cambodian craft — and to own it.

o8 Who We're For

Four audiences. The first two buy the tin; the last two buy the range.

The Host at Home

35–60. Cooks with care. Reads the label before the logo. Has strong feelings about olive oil and an opinion on which flour rises best. Buys one tin of Pure for themselves, then comes back for Herbes when they realise how quickly the first tin disappears on the table. Lives in a major city and entertains at home most weekends.

Buys because — a beautiful ingredient earns a place in a kitchen they care about.

The Gift-Giver

Buys for a birthday, a dinner invitation, a corporate hamper, a wedding. Wants an object that says 'I thought about this' without saying 'I spent too much.' The magnetic-close box does half the work; the 24k Gold SKU does the other half when the occasion warrants.

Buys because — it looks as considered as the relationship.

The Hospitality Buyer

F&B director or procurement lead at a four- or five-star hotel, a fine-dining restaurant, or a boutique concept store. Needs products that survive a plate check, a service audit, and a guest photograph. Values consistency, lead-time clarity, and a supplier who picks up the phone.

Buys because — it earns its place on the table without apology, and the supplier is easy to work with.

The Export Distributor

Specialty food importer in Japan, Korea, Singapore, France, or the Gulf. Looks for products with a clear origin story, credible design, and margin headroom to survive duty and three-step distribution. Wants a brand that will still be alive in five years.

Buys because — the category is proven, the product is differentiated, and the founders are reachable.

09 Voice & Tone

Three voice pillars

- **Restrained** — we do not exclaim. We do not use three adjectives where one will do. White space and short sentences do a lot of the work.
- **Rooted** — we speak from a place. Kampot, the coast, the pans, the wind. We name things.
- **Warm, not cold** — quiet luxury is not the same as aloofness. We are proud of what we do, pleased to tell you about it, and happy to hand you a tin.

We do

- Use French alongside English where it earns its place — fleur de sel, à la main, Label Rouge.
- Name places, people-categories, materials, and methods.
- Write in complete sentences, in paragraphs. Bullet lists only for specification, not for storytelling.
- Use 'we' sparingly. Use 'you' even more sparingly.
- Let the product be the subject more often than the brand.

We don't

- Use superlatives: 'best', 'finest', 'world's most'. The object earns those words without our help.
- Use exclamation marks in brand copy.
- Lean on Angkor, temples, or tuk-tuks as shorthand for Cambodia.
- Claim certifications we don't yet hold (notably: organic, until documentation is confirmed).
- Talk about ourselves where the salt could be doing the talking.

Register cheat-sheet

- **Website / tin / box** — editorial, short, evocative. Think Hermès, Aesop, Le Labo.
- **Trade / wholesale** — confident, specific, numeric. Weight, mineral content, lead time, MOQ.
- **Social** — restrained. One image, one sentence. No emoji. No hashtag spam.
- **Press** — third-person, factual. Provenance, method, founders (when named), distribution.

10 Copy Library

Vetted language that can be used verbatim. Use these before inventing.

Tagline

A whisper of the Ocean, a Touch of Perfection.

One-line elevator (≤ 15 words)

Hand-harvested Kampot fleur de sel, presented in a tin worthy of the finest tables.

Three-line elevator (≤ 60 words)

Garuda is a super-premium Cambodian fleur de sel from the clay pans of Kampot, hand-harvested in small batches and presented in a magnetic-close gift tin. Four expressions — Pure, Cold Smoked, Herbes de Provence, and 24k Gold — each designed to earn its place on the tables of fine hotels, restaurants, and considered homes.

Paragraph pitch (≤ 150 words)

Garuda takes the flower of Kampot's salt — the thin crust of crystals that forms on the pans when the wind is right — and treats it with the care the category has long reserved for Guérande and Maldon. Sourced through a Kampot cooperative rooted in fair trade and women's employment, hand-packed in food-grade tins, and presented in a magnetic-close gift box, the range comprises four expressions: Pure, Cold Smoked, Herbes de Provence (with Label Rouge herbs from a cooperative in Aix-en-Provence), and 24k Gold. The name honours the great eagle of Khmer myth, carved into Angkor a thousand years before the first salt pan was cut. The intent is simple: to put Cambodia on the shelf where the world's finest salts already sit.

House phrases (use freely)

- "The flower of the salt."
- "Hand-harvested. Hand-packed. Nothing else added — unless the label says so."

- "A sweet finish, not a sharp one."
- "Worthy of the finest tables."
- "Cambodia, presented properly."
- "The tin is the homage."

Forbidden phrases

- "Himalayan pink salt" (wrong origin, wrong category, wrong brand).
- "Superfood."
- "Mother Nature."
- "Ancient wisdom."
- "Luxurious" (we show it; we don't claim it).
- "Organic" — until we have the certification to back it.

11 Brand Rules (What We Won't Do)

A short list. Easier to hold the line when it is written down.

- **We won't discount the flagship range** — for any reason other than a formal trade programme. Discounts trained on consumers teach the market the wrong price.
 - **We won't private-label for anyone** — in year one. Our name earns the reputation before someone else's does.
 - **We won't extend into pepper, sauces, spices, or gift hampers** — until the salt range is fully established. Range discipline is a moat; range sprawl is a warning sign.
 - **We won't list on general marketplaces** — (Amazon, Shopee, Lazada) until we have at least one year of curated hospitality distribution. Channel sequencing is brand-building; channel sprawl is brand-erosion.
 - **We won't name individual founders** — in outward copy until we are ready to stand behind each name personally. The product is the protagonist.
 - **We won't claim 'organic' anywhere** — (label, site, trade materials) until the cooperative's certification is confirmed in writing. Unverifiable claims are legal risk and brand risk in the same breath.
 - **We won't use stock imagery of Cambodia** — (sunsets over rice paddies, Angkor, monks, tuk-tuks) anywhere in our visual identity.
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12 The Measure

If a chef in Paris, a buyer in Tokyo, and a host in Phnom Penh all reach for the same tin for the same reason — because it is serious, considered, and unmistakably Cambodian — this document has done its job.

Everything else is execution.

— end —